Kayla Cha
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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley — ***Berkeley, California***
Major: Economics — *2025-Present*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Project: Optimizing Asset Class for Machine Learning — *Los Angeles, CA*
Co-Author — *Jan 2024 - Aug 2025*

- Wrote and co-authored a research paper that emphasizes how asset class selection impacts the effectiveness of ML investment strategies
- Conducted research with Stanford and UCLA to analyze how machine learning models such as Linear Regression, Random Forest, LSTM can predict price across asset classes such as Russell 2000 and Gold
- Built predictive models through financial indicators and evaluated performance, found that gold showed the highest predictive accuracy, while stocks are difficult to model effectively

CITY Educational Equity Initiative — *Los Angeles, CA*
Program Director — *Aug 2022 - May 2026*

- Directed a STEM equity initiative delivering drones, robotics, and coding resources throughout Title 1 schools across Los Angeles to address educational disparities
- Developed an outreach strategy to secure funding and ensured the timely distribution of robotics equipment to expand access to low-income students
- Established partnerships with district officials and local stakeholders to improve program performance to strengthen engagement

Polymarket — *Los Angeles, CA*
Growth Marketing Associate — *May 2026- Present*

- Increased campus user acquisition by promoting referral campaigns while educating students on prediction markets
- Promoted referral campaigns across a campus network of 1,000+ students, increasing user interest and peer-to-peer marketing
- Created peer-to-peer marketing strategies through campus outreach and social media platforms to expand brand visibility among college students

PROJECT & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Labor Rights Advocacy — *Los Angeles, CA*
Project Manager — *Sep 2024 - Present*

- Conducted market research and analysis on nonprofit advocacy models to recognize funding gaps, structured a revenue strategy, and built fundraising initiatives for the National Employment Law
- Leveraged data analytics to optimize outreach campaigns, evaluated engagement throughout digital platforms, and built partnerships to expand program reach to increase organizational sustainability

Teen Court — *Los Angeles, CA*
Juror and Executive Director — *Sep 2022-Jun 2025*

- Served as a juror in Teen Court and analyzed legal cases for students facing possible incarceration, introducing an alternative opportunity by facing probation, service hours, and GPA standards, encouraging rehabilitation
- Directed program operations by recruiting students, collaborating with judges and student jurors to evaluate evidence, streamlining case schedules to maximize the efficiency of court cases and raised $10,000

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills: Excel, PowerPoint, Google Sheets, data analysis, forecasting, machine learning models, company research, industry research, outreach, financial modeling, pitch deck
Interests: Investment banking, private equity, search funds, startups